MC

Title:
How Tybalt Capulet (Almost) Saved Italy

Author:
JD Holzmann

© 2017 JD Holzmann

Published by
MUSHROOM CLOUD PRESS

a division of
BIG RODENT PRODUCTIONS
Orlando, FL

Permission for performance of this piece is granted for the purpose of performance in competition by middle school, high school, and undergraduate collegiate performers. Theatrical performance and all other kinds of public performance, whether broadcast, online, or on stage, are prohibited without prior written permission from Mushroom Cloud Press.

This script is authorized for competition only if the competitor or the competitor's representative, including but not limited to parent or educational entity, have purchased a copy of the script from Mushroom Cloud Press or an authorized retailer. The script must be presented with the cover sheet bearing the ISBN. Additional requirements for performance may be made by tournament and league rules.

League officials: please contact Mushroom Cloud Press to validate script purchase.

Inquiries, sales, and service with a smile:
MushroomCloudPress.com
"Winning Rounds Since 2000"

How Tybalt Capulet (Almost) Saved Italy
JD Holzmann

TYBALT:
I am a tragic hero. Not just because I'm so tragically handsome. Ok, well that's part of it. But, I'm so much more. I
[dramatic pause]
Am Tybalt Capulet, famed swordfighter, wealthy noble, slayer of Montagues.
So, here is my tragic story of woe and triumph. You know the beginning.
In fair Verona we lay our scene et cetera et cetera.
My morning started when I woke up, obviously. I really hate Romeo Montague, I thought. To put in perspective, he's basically the guy we all knew in high school with dyed black hair always in his eyes and black skinny jeans who wrote lyrics like "I am the foil to this bright delusion called day." He was so dramatic. He called my sister a nun just because she didn't like him.

ROMEO:
Oh, Benvolio!
Good friend, oh woe
Is me!
How can it be
That she does not love me?

BENVOLIO:
Romeo. Relax.

ROMEO:
Look at the facts!
Explanations! There is only one!
My fair Rosaline is a nun!

TYBALT:
What kind of conclusion is that? You're not the best looking man in Verona, Montague.
[Hair flip]
I mean.

So, everything really started that fateful afternoon. Rosaline was preparing for the party that night. She had also denied Romeo Montague. I'm so proud of her.

ROSALINE:
Tybalt, does this necklace go with this dress?

TYBALT:

No. It looks cheap. Like something a *Montague* would wear.

ROSALINE:
You have a point. Speaking of the Montagues, that Romeo has found favour in me.

TYBALT:
[in disgusted shock]
Romeo Montague?

ROSALINE:
The only Romeo we know.

TYBALT:
That detestable man! Say it's not so!
Say you aren't loved by that Romeo!

ROSALINE:
[done.]
He's rhyming again.

TYBALT:
Can I stand his unforgivable sin?

ROSALINE:
Your perspective's a bit...askew

TYBALT:
You got that from your precious Montague!

ROSALINE:
Tybalt.

TYBALT:
Perfection.
[beat]
As I was saying, that necklace looks cheap. Like the Montagues. New money, no doubt. Those Montagues know nothing of tradition!

ROSALINE:
Their money's as old as ours.

TYBALT:
Those Montagues told you that! It's a plan! It's a conspiracy! They're clever, those Montagues. Not smart, but clever. Those-

ROSALINE:
Say ‘Montagues’ one more time and I’ll hurt you.

TYBALT:
Say no more, sister Rosaline, for I
Leave until the festivities of night.
I bid you farewell, leave with a couplet,
Until tonight with cousin Juliet.

Thus, I went out to prove that precious Romeo wasn’t the only man in Verona who could rhyme.

He thinks he has such a talent for it
But he doesn’t know, doesn’t know a bit
Of what Tybalt Capulet can do now!

So, I went out into town. And who did I see? None other than that villain Romeo. He was being as Montague-esque as usual. Meaning sad. As the Montagues are sad excuses for human beings. Honestly, the world would be so much better off without them. Wait! That can be arranged.

Uncle, I want to stab him.

CAPULET:
Tybalt no.

TYBALT:
But-

CAPULET:
Tybalt no.

TYBALT:
So I just confronted Benvolio.

Ay Benvolio!

BENVOLIO:
What?

TYBALT:
It appears I’ve broken a mirror recently.

BENVOLIO:
With a face like yours, I’m not surprised.

TYBALT:

You’re one to know about that, aren't you? But the curse of thirteen misfortunate years arrived when you did.

As you can see, I’m what the kids call savage.

As I was saying, Montague, look upon thy death.

BENVOLIO:
CAn’t a guy get some peace-

TYBALT:
What, drawn and talk of peace! I hate the word as I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee.

BENVOLIO:
What?

TYBALT:
Have at thee, coward!

And thus we, and much of our families, fought. I valiantly led the fray, leading to yet another Capulet victory. I know, I know. I’m such a hero. But just sitting there was perfect Romeo.

ROMEO:
Woe!
Woe is me!
Woe is that she,
That she, the bright morning star
Doesn’t care for who I are!

BENVOLIO:
Am.

ROMEO:
That perfect lamb!
The nun!
Love, her heart has none.
Oh, my life is done!

BENVOLIO:
Chill. Please. You’re killing me.

ROMEO:
Love is killing me!

BENVOLIO:
[sigh]

Ok that servant said there was gonna be a party right? We should go.

ROMEO:
I cannot, dear Benvolio!

BENVOLIO:
There will be girls.

ROMEO:
I'm game.

TYBALT:
Thus, Romeo and his company showed up to the party my uncle was throwing for Juliet. And trust me, his company isn't exactly likeable. The worst is that scum Mercutio. He loves nothing more than what he calls comedy. He's a child, I'm telling you. I could be holding a sword to his throat and he'd say,

MERCUTIO:
Alright mate. I get the *point* but you can *cut it out* now. Eh? Eh?

TYBALT:
He's the disgrace of Italy.

But, I was casually enjoying the party. Dancing, talking, the like, and then I hear *it*.
That *Montague* Romeo was there. Talking about my cousin Juliet. Can I just take a moment to bring up how disturbing this is? So, I decided to take the necessary measures.

Uncle, Romeo Montague's here.

CAPULET:
That's great, Tybalt.

TYBALT:
He's killing my vibe and I won't endure him!

CAPULET:
Tybalt, chill.

TYBALT:
Imma stab him.

CAPULET:
Tybalt no.

TYBALT:
Tybalt yes.

CAPULET:
Tybalt this is literally your 14 year old cousin's birthday party.

TYBALT:
I mean. It's not like it's a sin to kill him, Uncle.

CAPULET:
Maybe tomorrow.

TYBALT:
But-

CAPULET:
Don't stab him.

TYBALT:
Old man ruins all the fun. So, I had to tolerate Romeo's detestable presence all night. And shockingly, he didn't ruin anything. Until the very end, when I heard that he had deceived Juliet into loving him. How someone could do that, I'll never know. I knew he'd be the death of her and me both. I swore to end him or die trying. Thus, I spent my time plotting.

Rosaline, I'm plotting!

ROSALINE:
That's great.

TYBALT:
Juliet, I'm plotting to kill your boyfriend.

JULIET:
Oh, but my dear cousin Tybalt, why?
My love does not deserve to die.

TYBALT:
Dear Juliet, you ask me why?

JULIET:
Ay.

TYBALT:
For he has shamed
Our family name!

JULIET:

He brings no shame!

TYBALT:
They're all the same!
Those Montagues
You have no clue
He's using you!

JULIET:
You lie!

TYBALT:
You deny!

Nurse, keep her here. I'm going back to plotting.

NURSE:
That's great. Actually, that reminds me of the time when you-

TYBALT:
Don't finish that statement.

I spent the rest of the day plotting more. Then, it hit me. Well, Rosaline more or less threw it at me.

ROSALINE:
Hey, idiot. You left your hat in the living room again.

TYBALT:
That hat!
That hat that-

ROSALINE:
Stop rhyming.

TYBALT:
Fine. This hat. This hat that I was going to wear to Juliet and Paris' wedding. The same hat I wore during *[slowing down]* that I wore during the party. When I saw Romeo.
That's it!

ROSALINE:
Here we go.

TYBALT:
I'll kill him after Juliet and Paris' wedding!
[louder]

You hear that, Verona? Tybalt Capulet shall slay Romeo and save all Italy!

I went out the next morning to tell everyone the good news. Then I saw Benvolio and Mercutio. The villains were talking about me and that repulsive Montague. I was so enraged, I decided not to wait until after the wedding. I'd act as soon as I saw him. I decided to interrupt them in order to ask for Romeo.

Good day, gentlemen. A word with one of you, if you please.

MERCUTIO:
Just one singular word?

TYBALT:
More like a question. Where might one be able to obtain information as to where your leader Romeo currently takes up space?

BENVOLIO:
What?

TYBALT:
I'll put it in terms even a Montague would understand: Where Romeo?

MERCUTIO:
No idea. But you like fighting people, right?

TYBALT:
I suppose.

MERCUTIO:
Fight me.

TYBALT:
What?

MERCUTIO:
Fight. Me.

TYBALT:
No.

MERCUTIO:
Why won't you fight me?

ROMEO:
Mercutio, who are you trying to fight now?

MERCUTIO:
The crazy cat lady.

ROMEO:
Tybalt?

MERCUTIO:
Yeah.

TYBALT:
Excuse.

MERCUTIO:
Ignore the cat lady Bromeo.

ROMEO:
If you insist, MercutiBro.

TYBALT:
What am I witnessing?

MERCUTIO:
Shut him up, BenvoliBro.

TYBALT:
Put me out of my misery.

MERCUTIO:
Gladly.

TYBALT:
So we fought. I, of course, won. Poor fool didn't stand a chance. I fled the scene to spread the word. I was proud. The fool needed to die. His puns were killing the crowd. And then I returned.

ROMEO:
Not cool bro.

TYBALT:
You dating my cousin isn't cool 'bro'.

ROMEO:
Excuse you, I married her.

TYBALT:
When?

ROMEO:
Bout an hour ago.

BENVOLIO:
Really? And I wasn't best man?

ROMEO:
Sorry, man. We wanted it to be really lowkey.

BENVOLIO:
Nah I get it.

TYBALT:
Are we gonna fight or nah? I just kinda killed your friend so.

ROMEO:
Oh right.

TYBALT:
And that, dear audience, is where this hero turns tragic. I fought flawlessly, as usual. But Romeo was better than I took him for. After a long struggle, I did fall. Dying to defend my cause.
My blood stained the streets, never to forget
The tragedy of Tybalt Capulet.